

Hollerbier Haven

Newsletter for Herbal and Healing Arts



Reaping the Harvest

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The seeds that we planted in the darkness of late winter have sprouted, blossomed, and now begun to bear fruit! Certainly, there have been some long rows to hoe, some weeds to pull and yes, even a torrential downpour or two. But we are grateful for all of it and continue to tend our new 'garden' with love and dedication. We take the challenges the wind blows across our fields as a chance to learn and grow. As we continue to cultivate the precious soil of our projects we continually find opportunities to recommit ourselves and reaffirm the work we do.

In the past few months, we've held several workshops at the PA German Cultural Heritage Center in Kutztown, and thoroughly enjoyed our time teaching and sharing with those who came. Due to the outpouring of interest for our project and newsletter, we went to a second printing and sent out over 400 copies of the premier issue.

Our Hollerbier Haven Guild meetings at the Farm at Coventry in Pottstown have been a joy to host. Spending time in the garden connecting with the plants has been enlightening. We've also connected with many new faces as well as old friends, each bringing their own passions to our gatherings.

Two recent articles in Allentown's Morning Call newspaper have featured the Three Sisters Center and have opened many doors for us.

We are honored to have been con-

tacted by several Brauchers, all of whom have invited us to interview them and share in their knowledge. The initial article from the Morning Call was picked up and reprinted in papers around the country. We are pleased (and just a little surprised) that word of our project has been so far-reaching and touched so many people.

We want to thank all those who have come out in support of the Three Sisters Center and the work we are doing.

With the recent inclusion of our website we will have the opportunity to reach many more, potentially furthering our ability to share the healing traditions of the PA Germans.

Already we have begun to save our seeds and plan our fields for next year. The quiet work of the winter will no doubt, be keeping us busy and sustaining us as we dream, study and stitch the winter months away.

-Jesse and Susan





The Doctrine of Signatures

The doctrine of signatures is an ancient European philosophy that held that plants bearing parts that resembled human body parts, animals, or other objects, had useful relevancy to those parts, animals or objects. It could also refer to the environments or specific sites in which plants grew. Many of the plants that were so regarded today still carry the word root "wort", an Anglo-Saxon word meaning "plant" or "herb", as part of their modern name.

The German visionary Jakob Böhme (1575-1624), a master shoemaker of Görlitz, had a profound mystical vision as a young man, in which he saw the relationship between God and man signaled in all things. Inspired, he wrote *Signatura Rerum* (1621), soon translated to English and called *The Signature of all Things* and the spiritual doctrine was applied even to the medicinal uses that plants' forms advertised.

English astrologer and herbalist, Nicholas Culpeper's often reprinted herbal takes the doctrine of signatures as common knowledge, and its influence can be detected still in modern herbal lore. The doctrine of signatures was expounded in mainstream medical texts into the 19th century and has remained a working principle of homeopathic medicine.

For more information regarding the Doctrine of Signatures, see page 18 and attend a workshop with Minnesota herbalist, Matthew Wood. He is the author of *The Book of Herbal Wisdom, Seven Herbs: Plants as Teachers*, *The Practice of Traditional Western Herbalism*

Vinegar of the Four Thieves

"During the height of the plague in France in 1721, it was discovered that the homes of disease victims were being ransacked. At first, no effort was made to find the criminals, since all knew they were fools, soon to die of the plague themselves. As time went on, it became apparent that the thieves were continuing in their raids... and quite inexplicably, avoiding falling victim to the disease. Soon, they became highly sought after—not due to their crimes, but in an effort to learn their secret. When they were finally captured, they refused to speak, until a bargain was offered: Remain silent and hang. Divulge the secret to their resistance to the deadly plague and walk away. It seems that the mother of several of the boys was a midwife, and had a recipe which used plants which were easily wild crafted... yet, she knew that this would change immediately if anyone learned the formula, so she swore her children to secrecy. Her sons saved their necks and shared the recipe for the disinfectant anyway, which is still used in France to this day."

You can make your own **Four Thieves Vinegar** by following the simple recipe below. Use equal parts of the following herbs:

- Lavender
- Sage
- Rosemary
- Thyme
- Lemon Balm
- Hyssop
- Peppermint
- A handful of garlic cloves, coarsely chopped

Chop and blend ingredients. Fill a glass mason jar with the herbs and cover completely with organic, unpasteurized apple cider vinegar, which is available in most health food stores. Cold infuse (let sit at room temperature in a cool place) for six to eight weeks, shaking occasionally and then strain off herbs and garlic.

Some other additions, in lesser amounts might be juniper berries, whole cloves, cinnamon, nutmeg, angelica root. Many of the old recipes call for rue or wormwood; however these are toxic and should not be added if the vinegar is to be ingested.

You can take Four Thieves Vinegar by the teaspoonful (it is quite delicious!), use it in a salad dressing, or even add some to your bath water for personal protection. You can also use it as a topical spray to disinfect surfaces—including skin—and/or you can take it as a tincture. All of the ingredients in Four Thieves Vinegar are either potent antibacterials or antivirals.



In modern Braucherei the sisters are called "die Drei Schwestere" or collectively "Sophia". Their function is much the same as before, unchanged since the time of our most ancient ancestors. It is these sisters who spin the web that we travel through when we do Zeidschtrick (Timecord work).

They have been the guiding hand creating each strand, each thread, each person's cord. They are the guardians of this web, and of the arts of binding fibers. When we encounter them in the Zeidschtrick they can teach us how to spin and weave our cords ourselves, how to find our own power, how to make our own destiny within the harmonious beauty of the tapestry they weave.

Sometimes the Three Sisters are incorporated into Bedeheelen (prayer healing). In this case the Braucher spends time in prayer and meditation first with the male trinity: God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit. Second the Braucher calls upon the three sisters: the maiden, the mother, and the crone. The sisters often reveal messages and knowledge to the Braucher in this time. The sisters bring balance to the Brauchers work, as well as wisdom and the promise of fruitful

We have called our center "Three Sisters Center for the Healing Arts" because we see a need for balance in our world. In many places the three sisters' place in the tradition has been forgotten, and we hope to recall it to the practice. We have called upon them to guide our work, along with their brothers, restoring our fragmented tatters of culture into the beautiful quilt it once was and will be again.

The Three Sisters are the feminine aspect of the trinity in the Braucherei tradition. In Braucherei there is always the need for balance. We pass the tradition from man to woman, from woman to man. We give honor to the healing properties of all four elements, all four stages in life, all four seasons. It is the same when we see the presence of the masculine and feminine in everything, offering wisdom in the equilibrium of nature.

Before the Christian times in Germany, the trinity that was most honored and understood as all powerful was the Wyrd Sisters. There were three: the maiden, the mother, and the crone. These three existed outside of the universe, outside of creation. They were the creators and destroyers. The crone spun strands of reality from the void. The mother carefully wove them into the web of existence. The maiden looks to find those strands that have become worn or are no longer serving their function, and tears them back to nothing.

~Sophia~

Since times of old we've told the tale
Of sisters three behind the veil

The maiden, mother, and elder wise
Who spin from naught the web of lives

The stars, the sky, our sacred land
They spin and weave with guiding hands

For every life they make a vow
To guide and light a way somehow

They make a prayer and spin a thread
The path is made, the blessing said

To grow each tiny spark of light
To brighten paths in dark of night

As elder sisters weave and spin
The youngster wears a knowing grin.
For as they weave the frail threads in
She deftly pulls them out again.

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The Path of Many Paths...

Braucherei is by its nature a path of many paths. It is a river of wisdom into which many tributaries have coursed. When it reaches the sea of people by whom it must be carried, it is a delta, wide and diffuse rivulets of knowledge flowing in every direction but ultimately ending in the same purpose: wholeness, oneness, union with the larger spirit that encompasses us all.

I have heard again and again, from many mouths about the "correct" way to practice, the "authentic" way to make a prayer, the "truth" of the tradition. These blanket statements have come from every angle: Christian, Pagan, academic, and folkloric. So many people seem to have interviewed one or two Braucherei practitioners and have decided that the truth they received is the only valid truth. If there is one thing I have learned from the stories and practices of the various practitioners who have shared their tales with me, my teacher, Dennis, and my partners, Matthew and Susan, it is that there is a different path to healing for every single person in this wide and beautiful world. In our collective study of the Braucherei tradition there have been three well springs of knowledge upon which we have relied: 1) the direct oral tradition teachings of Elder Brauchers; 2) the written wisdom of mystics, historians, and scholars; and 3) the Spirit of wisdom that exists in our own hearts and connects us with the spirit present in every living thing.

Many wish to define Braucherei, pin it down, learn if and how it works, and discern it from other traditions. They want to document every cure, every prayer and every story. Ultimately however, this way of study will yield nothing but words on paper. It will not ensure the survival of the practice, and it will not bring the scholar to an understanding of the practice itself. The tradition itself defies definition. It refuses to be bridled. This is why we Brauchers cannot say whether or not a cure is possible; for there is no harness to spirit, it moves as it will, all we can do is hope and try to act as an open channel through which it can move.

To attempt understanding through a preservation of individual cures on paper is folly. It is akin to killing a beautiful bird, dissecting it, and placing its individual organs in jars of formaldehyde on the shelf to be studied. Perhaps the scholar can understand how certain organs interact, how a muscle contracts to drive a beating heart, lungs, wings; but there is no answer to why. Why does it breathe, hurt, heal, live, and die? These answers do not come in the form of words, words cannot hold them. They come only in the experience of spirit driving a heart to beat, a seed to sprout, the wind to blow. Clear borders and boundaries are a human invention: the line between sand and sea is always shifting, and the border between field and forest requires constant vigilance. No matter how tirelessly we toil to maintain the lines and boundaries we create, they always return to the slow, blurred borders of the natural world. So too, that which can be defined as Braucherei is different in each pair of eyes, each mind, each heart.

The Braucherei tradition, as all culture, language, and traditions, and as every natural system on earth, has always been driven by that which is useful. Kabala was included because of the truth of its teachings; the knowledge of the Greeks learnt its understanding of natural rhythms; the beliefs of the ancient Germanic tribes was the clear beating heart of a people; the wisdom of the Gnostics and later the German mystics gave an understanding of Christianity that did not condemn the inherent wisdom of a people, but simply built upon it.

It is not just Braucherei that refuses to be defined, it is culture itself. The living evolving being of language, art, religion, and healing that lives in our bones and our blood refuses to be static. How can it? That which becomes static and refuses to change or grow, as the natural world requires, quickly dies. It is the same with the spirit in every heart. The web of existence is continuously nebulous, bleeding across every line that can be drawn.

In our commitment to the revival and remembrance of Braucherei wisdom we must also have knowledge of the culture from which it sprang. We must feed and care for this culture, recognizing that though this wisdom of healing and spirit may be the beating heart it cannot live without the being as a whole.

Most importantly, we cannot force our will upon this being, try to enslave it, or keep it to what it once was. Not only will its health and vitality decline, its beauty ebb; but we will have missed the point: to make the wisdom our own, to add what wisdom we can to this heirloom, to keep it vital and full, to pass it on in a state even stronger than when it found us. We have committed ourselves to openness in our mission of cultural revival. This means openness to every truth that can be spoken. After all, if Braucherei is a folk tradition, who better to teach it than the folk? Who better to learn it and carry it on than the folk? So we learn and keep alive the words of our elders, we enrich this knowledge with the wisdom of our hearts, and we rely on the hearts and hands of those yet to come to carry this heirloom as it has always been carried: with spoken word and open heart, from elder to apprentice, from person to person.

There are those who seem terrified that we will lose our path if we do not set it in stone. I hope to reassure them: the path that is lost was not meant to be had; the path set in stone cannot grow or change as a deer path in the woods, but is fixed in its purpose and function.

Already we have seen those bits of Braucherei that have been set to stone create an understanding of Braucherei that is dogmatic and empty. Dogma has a place on the healing path: it gives form and function. If, however, we rely on dogma alone to show us the path, wisdom is quickly replaced by ego, and spirit cannot flow where ego blocks the way. It is the light of spirit in the heart and soul of every being that serves to guide them on their path in life. This light makes a path in the wilderness where once there was none. It releases us from the bonds of pain in our bodies, hearts, and souls. It returns us to a state of wholeness and union with divine nature. We have spent too much time looking at our differences, dividing ourselves, and attempting to maintain purity. If there is one thing I am sure of in the future that stretches before us, it is that we must learn to see our commonalities, not only our differences. Diversity is beauty; it creates the same richness in human culture as it does in healthy ecosystems. In ecosystems, however, the many diverse aspects of the natural system have learned to work together to the greatest benefit of all. Perhaps it is time for us humans to sit back from our ego driven and imagined control of our natural world, perhaps it is time to pay attention to what the natural world is telling us. The light is present, my friends, and the wisdom of Braucherei living in the flesh and blood of our elders, our descendants, and ourselves. The path shines out before us, and I pray that we have the courage and faith to follow, to bring our communities, our world, and our selves to wholeness.



Harvest Moon: Shedding Light on Ourselves



The Harvest Moon is the full moon nearest to the autumnal equinox, which occurs (in the northern hemisphere) on or about the 23rd day of September. In 2007, the equinox does indeed fall on Sunday, September 23 and the full moon follows a few days later on Wednesday, September 26.

Historically, the full Harvest Moon became known and celebrated as the occasion when farmers were gifted with extra available light to continue bringing in their harvests even after the sun went down. Along with the extra hard work, much celebration, feasting, dancing and thanksgiving accompanied this full moon.

Even if you have no agricultural lineage in your blood, imagine yourself a part of this ancient rhythm of satisfying work, followed by joyous celebration and thanksgiving at the Harvest Moon. Instead of bounty collected from tended farmland, there are many other fruits you may have reaped from worthwhile effort this year.

You might imagine yourself climbing, with strength and purpose, to the highest point of a mountain on the Harvest moonlit night. A beautifully woven harvest basket carrying a small blanket, bountiful offerings and thanksgiving prayers is strapped to your shoulders.

As you ascend from the shadows at the very base of the mountain, what can you see around you, as you climb, guided, hand and foot by the radiance of this moon? With each step, you are shedding the dusk and shadow that dim your view. As you turn your face up to face the moon, your whole being becomes awash with

clear vision of outer vistas and inner knowing. Your strength and stamina seem to be building; your sight and perception is becoming increasingly clear the higher you climb. Your footing and grip made secure by the growing luminosity around you. It is a worthwhile climb.

As you reach the pinnacle, you witness below, the exquisite landscape of your life this year, illuminated in a perfect complete circle around you. You remove your basket from your shoulders and carefully spread your blanket, leave your offerings and whisper your thanksgiving prayers for this clear vision of your personal harvest season. By the illumination of this Harvest Moon, it has all been made abundantly clear to you.

You marvel at the expanse of fertile fields below, seen clearly in various stages of cultivation. You deeply understand the complex beauty of the efforts of your work and relationships; the patchwork of projects and dreams, small and large. While breathing in this illuminated beauty, sit with your back against the mountain top and take some time to reflect on a few questions and their answers:

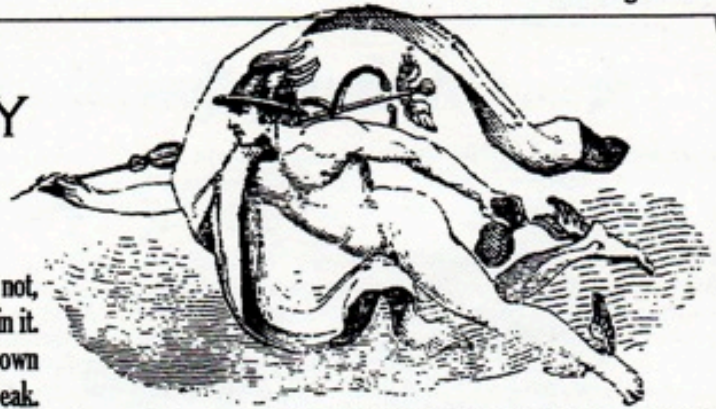
Are you aware of the many seeds you have sown this year? Which ones have you carefully nurtured and brought to fruition? What field, if any, has been neglected, left unattended to grow weeds or an unhealthy crop? Is there work still to be done there? Unexpected gifts yet to be gleaned? Or rather, is it a field that remains fallow, turned under to rest until next spring? What have you harvested this year that has provided you with sustenance, deep satisfaction and nourishment? Which field, if any, hasn't provided food for your soul, and left you feeling hungry and unfulfilled?

The answers you seek may take the same effort put forth as the toiling farmer. Yet, take heart in knowing that some years, the sweat and struggle poured out, are less than others. When you make the descent down the mountain, be assured that your harvest basket will always be heavy with fruit. When illuminated from above there is always balance, always beauty, always something to harvest. The metaphor and exercise for the Harvest Moon can be utilized every full moon cycle and carried from month to month. You need not wait until the Harvest Moon to climb to the pinnacle.



SPEAK CLEARLY

by Matthew Sicher



Words can wield power, this is known. Spoken aloud or not, words can and do inform our perceptions of the world and our place in it. The words we use and believe not only influence the structure of our own perceptions, but also influence the many people with whom we speak. Every medicine path has a complete vocabulary to express the energies and techniques with which practitioners interact. So too is this the case within our German and Pennsylvania German medicine practices.

In the world of our healing arts practices, as we have been given them, many people speak of two types of practitioners. Some people within this magical, prayer-filled tradition practice Braucherei or Powwow, while some are known as practitioners of Hexerei. Some people think of these two types of practitioners as occupying totally different realms, of representing two different forces. Other people refer to Braucherei and Hexerei as two sides of the same fence, as two ends of a spectrum. Still others see the two as one and the same, two names for the same practice- whether for good or ill.

I have been taught by some practitioners that, "Brauchers get their power from God, and Hexers get their power from the Devil." Both attempt to influence the world around them, but acting out two entirely different agendas. All of our teachers have referred to the art they practice as Braucherei or Powwow. As part of that lineage I too refer to myself as a Braucher or Powwow.

Among the necessary rules guiding my practice as a Braucher is that I may never Powwow for someone without their knowledge, and I may not offer to Powwow. I may tell someone that I am a Braucher, but it is up to them to request help if they are seeking help. I have entered into a contract with God to help to guide a life into greater wholeness and harmony, that they may come into greater harmony with the presence of Divine Spirit of Creation in their life. I am never to Brauch for malevolent outcome, or for the detriment of another.

It is said however that one practicing Hexerei may act upon another not only without their consent, but may even cast hexes. To cast a hex can involve raising energy to actively initiate discord in the life of another. Hexes can be cast intentionally, but also removed intentionally. A Hexer may remove a hex by casting it onto another, whereas a Braucher will often break a hex by neutralizing it with prayer and incantation, or by casting it into an inanimate object.

A hex acts as a knot in the web of one's life, inappropriately constricting and redirecting the flow of one's life energies. A hex acts blinders that prevent the sufferer from perceiving the options surrounding them. A hex can act as a leash, binding the life of a person to the controlling will of the hexer. Hexes can be cast intentionally, but my teaching has shown that hexes are actually most frequently set unintentionally.

Every one of us may cast a hex onto the life of another if we live our lives without integrity or intentionality. One of my teachers

In ancient mythology, Mercury was the messenger of the Gods. He was young, beautiful and swift as the wind, for his feet had wings. His province was communication. In astrology, the planet Mercury is the internal messenger and rules the rational mind, language and all forms of communication, speech and writing, logic and reason.

taught that a common way for a hex to be put in place is when someone gives a "gift" out of malice, spite, or a sense of obligation fueled by resentment. The material item acts as a spiritual poison in the life of the receiver. Hexes can be cast by repeated or focused thoughts about, or directed toward someone, wishing for illness, discord, or malevolent influence in their life. When becoming lost in our own pain and loosing sight of the guiding Grace in our lives, we are all capable of hexing others, and this not only acts as a destructive force in the hexed person, but the power of the hex clings to the hexer as well, and may reek havoc in the lives of hexed and hexer alike.

With this understanding, it becomes clear that we all have the power to act as messengers of Divine Love, as well as arbiters of destructive stagnancy. One of our spiritual forefathers, Jacob Boehme remind us that our job in this life is to try to our utmost to grow the spark of Christ Consciousness within ourselves, to become as Christ. Every conscious being has the ability to either help themselves and others to move toward this goal of wholeness, or away from it. Influencing benevolent growth or malevolent stagnancy, acting as a conduit for angelic or demonic powers, these are the opposing energies with which life presents us.

Some practitioners of benevolent arts call themselves Hex Doctors or Hexenmeisters (the masters of witches). This is a common title for people in York and Adams Counties, as well as those along the Appalachian Mountains of the south, who would be called Brauchers in other places. What is in a name? Throughout much of the history of our Germanic folk beliefs and practices, a "Hexe" was not necessarily a title for someone practicing malevolent arts. In truth, the word, "hex" only denotes a magical or spiritual act- the intentional movement of energy. The word in and of itself does not connote dark magic. It is the cultural connotations that have come out of the influence of Christianization and the dark times of the witch trials that have made this connotation stick. In our current language and culture in south-eastern PA Braucherei I have seen this word used in other ways even despite the current connotations: "Hexedigger" simply means "magical objects", "Greiderhexe" translates to "plant magic", etc.

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Sommermit

Sacrifice is the meditation of this season, a concept which has held weight in all times for all people. Sacrifice is a word with many meanings. Most of us hold an image in our minds of sacrifice that is inherently gruesome: the ritual killing of an innocent victim to appease the gods. This popular understanding of sacrifice only reflects one of this word's definitions, however. Another meaning of the word is "to make sacred".

There is sacrifice everywhere in the living world: the plants and animals make sacrifices every day to our demands for hunger. The earth makes sacrifices for everyone of her children, and particularly her human ones. We take her sacrifice for granted in every action of our lives: our homes, our fuel, our food. Have you ever seen someone stop at a gas pump and say a prayer of thanks to all those who have given lives, home, and health so that this car could have fuel? Even eating many of us forget that what we eat was once alive, and it is only through its ultimate sacrifice that our bellies are full (many would love to forget this fact).

We sacrifice for our work, our loved ones, and even people we will never meet. Passion drives us to sacrifice- passion makes our work sacred. At Sommermit we celebrate sacrifice and the passion that drives us all to do the sacred work that ensures a healthy and beautiful future.

In ancient times there was an understanding of the year as a wheel in constant motion, a cycle of growth and decline. The time of Sommermit on August 1st is the time of ripening grain and the first grain harvest. Grain has a presence in the human mind that surpasses most other foods. Grain is sustenance itself. Every people in every corner of the earth have some wonderful starchy staple that they grow in massive quantities. Nothing can be grown, harvested, and stored as easily and effectively as grain, and since agriculture has come to the northern Europeans, grain has occupied a sacred place in our culture.

According to our ancient ancestors and our modern Braucherei tradition all living things have spirits and intelligence that is different than, but equal to our human minds and souls. Grain is understood to have such a soul. In ancient times grain was one of the most revered spirits of nature, and the cycle of life in the human world revolved around his story.

The corn man, or Butzeman as we call him now, is made from the last sheaves of the previous year's harvest. In early February he is fashioned into a human form and placed into the field where new grain is planted. This action returns the spirit of the grain to the seed so that it can sprout and grow again. It also sets the Butzeman, the father of this year's corn to watch and guard the growth of his children, ensuring fruitfulness once more. He watches over this growth until Sommermit, when the grain is mature and the harvest begins. Sommermit marks the death of father corn, his spirit has left the Butzeman and entered into the seed of the mature grain. In our folk tradition there is a belief that the Butzeman's



Der Butzeman

body must be burned in a sacred fire (like the Viking kings of old) to ensure that his body is returned to the earth. If this empty sheaf were not burned and honored in this way it would be open as a vessel for other spirits to reanimate it (many of whom might not be so benevolent). This ceremony is a funeral, giving thanks and honoring the spirit of the grain for its gift of life through its own sacrifice.

At Sommermit ceremony focuses on death and resurrection. The grain has died, has sacrificed his body willingly for our sustenance, through the winter months. In the cold and hungry times of winter he is our salvation from death. By his death he honors an ancient and sacred contract, a symbiosis between our species: He dies and gives his seed over to human hands, by doing so he ensures the survival and health of humans, and of his own children. Human hands keep safe this seed, till the earth, plant and cultivate through the season, and harvest again. This is the song we have made together, the agreement to allow each other to grow in health, safety, and comfort, and the knowledge of infinite renewal, even in the face of death.

At Sommermit we honor his willing sacrifice, and we honor our sacred contract. We mourn the passing of the lush green world to the dry stalks of august and September, but we welcome the coming of the harvest and the time of plenty. Harvest time is a time of sacrifice for humans too. To bring the harvest in is quite a chore, one that requires every able hand at every hour of the day for weeks at a time. In old times it was a season of sharing in labor with neighbors and friends, and sharing in wealth as well.

Continued on page 8...

HOLLERBIER HAVEN

Herbal and Healing Arts Guild

Guiding Principles and Philosophy

The purpose of the Hollerbier Haven Guild is to create a wider circle of friends who acknowledge the essential value of preserving traditional healing methods and who seek to honor and sustain them through personal and group endeavors.

We recognize.....

- the traditional wisdom and healing practices of our elders, with an emphasis on the rich cultural heritage of Pennsylvania and the people who settled here
- the essential worth of sustainable cultivation, conscious wild-crafting and harvesting plants with gratitude, in all efforts, small and large
- the many gifts of wild, native and cultivated plants and their contributions to the physical and spiritual well-being of the generations before us

We endeavor....

- to keep this traditional knowledge alive and vital through education, seasonal activities and a commitment to further exploration, research and sharing

A \$25 per year membership includes:

-Quarterly Guild Journal/Newsletter

-Early notification of all events and discounted fees for Guild Gatherings and workshops hosted by the Three Sisters Center for the Healing Arts www.ThreeSistersCenter.com

Sommermit continued from page 7...

Sharing in labor created an important bond between the people of a rural community. The season of sacrifice is here to remember that despite all of our grudges and squabbles it is the people here in our community that matter most to us. It is these people that we rely upon for support in times of need. If one farmer's crop failed in old times it was a huge burden to replace this sustenance for his family, but when this burden was spread out over an entire community it barely made a dent in the stores of food. Our plain brethren, the Mennonite and Amish still hold fast to this practice. They do not rely on insurances and welfare to save them when tragedy strikes; they rely entirely on each other. Often in this way they have recovered from the material damage of a severe storm or fire when the surrounding "fancy" neighbors are still doing paperwork.

One of the most ancient ceremonies of sacrifice and resurrection come in the form of breaking bread together. Cultures worldwide hold this practice as sacred: to come humbly to this sacred feast with friends and neighbors, and to share in the very body of that being that has saved us from starvation, to ingest this being in body and spirit. This sacred ceremony is as old as agriculture itself, perhaps older. It is positively because of the ubiquitous nature of this symbol of the harvest, of sacrifice and resurrection, and of strong and unconditional community that Christ chose the bread and the wine for his meal of remembrance.

On this day of sacrifice and resurrection take time to think on your life and your community. Can you sacrifice your pride to let go of a grudge? Can you resurrect a friendship that you thought irreparable? Think about strengthening community bonds. Take the example of the Butzeman and of Christ, sacrifice willingly- that is- make your work sacred through your passion. Bring the full strength and beauty of your sacred work to your community and to the world for the highest good of all. Allow spirit to move through you as you conduct tasks you think are mundane. All of this work must be done and done again, the cycles and patterns of human life in nature. We must all sacrifice to ensure that next spring there will be grain to plant, and hands to tend and harvest.

Jake, Der Holzman

The material below refers to a Braucher of my acquaintance. I met him in the Fredericksville Hotel in the mid-1960s. I never had an opportunity to interview him and ask him about his Pow Wow practice or catalog his experience in the way I later did with over seventy other Brauchers.

My own recollections of him were rather vague until a family member refreshed my memory. I simply recalled him working powwows for beers at the bar and sometimes resorting to cut tree branches in service of cures.

My relative told me more about Jake:

"Many people thought Jake's name was Holsman or Holtzman, but it wasn't. He was called that because he worked with wood. He had logged at one time and still sold some firewood. He had grown up in the woods and knew just about everything a fellow could know about trees. He split wood for posts or fence rails. He knew which bark was good for tea and if there was a persimmon or bearing chestnut within twenty miles he knew its location.

"Jake also knew how to use wood for other purposes. He knew which wood to use for a tool handle so you wouldn't have an accident. He knew different woods for dowsing or water-witching. He used willow to seek water, but he knew wood that could help you find anything from a buried survey stake to an unmarked grave.

"People would ask him what wood to use to give a licking to a kid. Jake knew which wood would teach which lesson. He knew what stick herded cows and which tended sheep. And people would come to him for Branch Cures. That's where he would give them the once over and figure out what they needed. Then he would go straight away to the woods and cut a branch off a living tree. He would brush over them lightly most times, like he was dusting them. But with some hard cases he might ask them to bend over so he could stiffly apply the cure to their rear ends.



"The ones I remember were oak for strength, maple for mellow disposition, birch for self discipline, pine for clear thinking, and willow for alleviating stiffness. There were others too, but I don't recall the specifics.

"There was a story in Rockland Township that Jake was a cunning pow wow doctor and had a good sense of humor. They say that one old farmer came into the hotel one day and said, 'Jake, I don't feel so good.' Jake looked him over and announced that he was easily curable. The farmer said, 'Well, how about you fix me and I buy you a little beer?' The farmer meant one of those six ounce glasses for draft beer. Jake looked at him and said 'I guess, buy me a little beer and I'll make you a little pow wow.' And so he did.

"Next day the farmer comes back and said, 'I feel a bit better, but I think I could use some more pow wow for a little beer.' Jake gave him a sly look and said, 'I guess, buy me a little beer and I'll make you a little pow wow.' And he did.

"This went on daily for several weeks until the farmer felt better than he ever had in his life. But he had a bit of a grudge that the healing had took so long. He insulted Jake in the hotel in front of the other customers, calling him Docktor Langsahm or slow doctor. Jake looked at him with confidence and said, 'If you weren't so cheap and had bought me a pitcher of beer and a few shots, you could have been fixed the first day'."

This story then made the rounds of a few other Brauchers, pow wow doctors, and prayer healers. Many thought there were lessons in the story about how we might best approach healing. The eighty-five year-old women from Longswamp summed it up best, "You mustn't hold back in healing from either side, trust and commitment must be there from both sides". Otherwise, it appears, the exchange is slow and miserly.

*Article contributed by Wisconsin author and storyteller Dennis Boyer. Please visit his website at www.Onceuponahex.com

MOUNTAIN MARY

Less than ten miles from my home, in the lush and fertile hills of Oley, Pennsylvania, located in what is now the southern part Berks County, lived a legendary woman that few are aware.

Sometime just prior to the start of the American Revolution, young Anna Maria Jung arrived in Philadelphia along with her parents and two sisters. The family had fled their farm in the Rhine River country to escape the religious persecution and wars that had ravaged and depleted that rich area of western Germany in previous centuries.

Like many others before them, The Jung family brought with them few possessions but proudly carried their valued traditions, customs, healing practices and stories to a land promised by William Penn to offer freedom, tolerance, peace and fertile farm land.

The Jung family purchased a 42 acre tract of land and moved north from Philadelphia to a steep, sloping hillside in the Oley hills, which was considered then to be the wild frontier of Penn's Woods. The rocky soil on the steep hillside made it difficult to plow, but they were blessed with a beautiful crystal clear flowing spring.

Soon after the family moved to Oley, Anna's father died, leaving his wife and three daughters to fend for themselves. Anna Maria Jung, or Mary Young as she came to be known, became an indentured servant to help pay for the land. She met a young German man, also an indentured servant, and they became betrothed. Unfortunately, her young fiancé joined Washington's Army and was killed in battle before they could be married. After such a deep sadness, Mary chose never to marry and to spend the rest of her life alone.

Over time her sisters married and moved away and Mary remained, living alone in her log cabin, for nearly forty years. Mary tended a few cows and it is said she made butter and cheese and carried it on her head over the hills to her closet neighbor three miles away who delivered it to sell at market in Philadelphia. She also was known to have kept hives of bees and had plenty of honey to barter for goods she needed.

But Mary was best known as a legendary herbalist who had a divine understanding of the healing qualities of roots and herbs. She had a prolific vegetable garden and a 'magical herb garden', as well. Her herb garden had dozens of plants that she used to make therapeutic teas, salves and poultices. Over time, word of her ability to help heal the sick and her goodwill offerings of food and herbal medicines, spread far and wide. She traveled great distances on foot to comfort the sick and nurture them back to health. She used a cane to maneuver through the steep and rocky terrain and was often seen smoking a corncob pipe while she walked.

Along with her vast knowledge of healing plants and good nutrition, Mary's deep and trusting faith in God made this gentle woman a strong and devoted servant of healing tradition. Prayer rituals, 'incantations' and the laying on of hands were essential parts of her healing practice. Some say she spent many hours memorizing bible passages and traveled with it wherever she went. It was said that she performed 'miraculous cures' and never required payment for her services.

There is much evidence to suggest that the early Pennsylvania Germans coexisted peacefully with the Lenni Lenape Indian tribes in the Oley Valley region for nearly a century. They traded goods and services and may well have shared healing techniques and herbal information, as well.

The traditional healing practice that Mountain Mary lived her life by is known as *Braucherei*, in the Pennsylvania Dutch dialect. Today that practice is more commonly known as Powwow. It is likely that the sharing and blending of healing practices with the Leni Lenape Indians was the reason why the name 'Powwow' was adopted. Powwow is taken from an Algonquin word for 'shaman'. Wonderful to imagine that a small elderly German woman who milked cows, smoked a pipe and used healing plants may have been respected as a shaman by her Native American neighbors!

In the first US census report in 1790, Mountain Mary was listed an 'Abbess' (or Holy Woman) as her occupation. Usually, 'abbess' is a term used to describe a religious female superior in an order of nuns. This may suggest that she had religious followers and some speculate that she was, with help from others, building a small church on the hillside where she lived.

Mountain Mary died at the age of 70 on November 16, 1819. It is documented that over one thousand people attended her funeral and traveled from as far away as New York City and Philadelphia to honor the life of the Highland

Healer. Apparently, in her will, Mary bequeathed her 40 acres of land to her niece as well as a few books and manuscripts.

In 1934, the Berks County Chapter of the Daughters of American Revolution honored Mountain Mary with a bronze marker placed near the site of her cabin that honored her as Pennsylvania's 'first visiting nurse'. On the monument is inscribed "To the memory of Mary Young-Mountain Mary-Barricke Mariche who lived to the south in these hills from early womanhood until her death, November 16th, 1819 at the age of seventy years. She was a pioneer nurse, comforter of body and soul, benevolent, pious, brave and charitable. She hath done what she could"

* The Pennsylvania German verb *brauche* means 'to need', 'to be of necessity', 'to use' or 'to try'. In High German, *ein Brauche* is a 'tradition or an heirloom'—something valued that is passed from one generation to the next.



Interesting Historical Facts and Folklore:

Germans considered mullein a benevolent, magical spirit that was helpful in times of danger and distress. Some old farmers still grow mullein near by houses and barns to keep lightning from striking there. As an herb of protection, it was also worn or hung as an amulet to neutralize hexes. One of mullein's common names was *Himmelbrand* or "heavenly fire".

Mullein also played a primary role in the ancient practice of herb blessing. Mullein was placed at the center of a bundle of nine herbs. Ritually placed around it were St John's Wort, yarrow, German chamomile, centaury, wormwood, valerian, peppermint and arnica. The bundle was taken to church on August 15 (which was the day celebrating the Ascension of Mary) to be blessed. The bundle was kept in the home near the hearth, and upon threat of thunder and lightning, pinches of it tossed into the fire as protection against volatile weather. An old rhyme goes: "Our beloved Lady goes through the land, she carries mullein in her hand." Sometimes, it was said that she used the mullein stalk as a means to touch and heal the sick.

When in flower, mullein resembles a large candle and the dried flower stalk were once dipped into fat or wax to serve as a primitive torch. Such torches were carried during various ceremonies, but particularly at funerals.

References:

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- A Modern Herbal- Mrs. M. Grieve (1931)

GREAT MULLEIN

Verbascum thapsus
Wollkraut, Candlewick plant,
Hag's Taper, Flannel leaf

Mullein leaf grows in disturbed or poor soil. This biennial has a rosette of woolly leaves and a tall, thick, downy, resinous stem of bright yellow flowers, followed by capsules containing many seeds. Gather leaf the first or second year but before the seed stalk forms. Flower stalks form the 2nd year.

Traditional medicinal uses: The expectorant, soothing, and spasm-sedating properties of the leaf is used to treat dry raspy coughs, bronchitis and irritated mucus membranes. If tea from the dried leaf is prepared it must be carefully strained through a tightly woven cloth to remove the tiny irritating hairs before drinking. Sauer recommends using the leaf topically in plasters or poultices to still pain. Also Mullein leaf vinegar can soothe inflammation, hemorrhoids or painful skin conditions. Leaves softened in hot water or milk may also be used this way topically. Traditionally, the leaf was also smoked for relief of bronchitis or asthma.

Olive oil infused with mullein flowers is a topical remedy for treating painful earaches, sore muscles and stiff necks.

Mullein root is a little known antispasmodic and sedative that is useful in treating facial nerve pain caused by TMJ, Bell's Palsy or trigeminal neuralgia. Combines well with St John's Wort for these conditions.

Hildegard Von Bingen used mullein for a hoarse voice, sore throat, or pain in the upper lungs caused by a sad heart.

SPEAK CLEARLY *Continued from Page 6*

With the adoption of Christianity by our ancestors, and subsequent purges of many aspects of life and spiritual practice considered "heathen" (lit. "dwelling on the heath" ie: country-dweller), the word "hex" or "hexe" took on distinctly negative connotations amongst many Pennsylvania German healing arts practitioners. In many parts of Europe, however, the Hexerei tradition is still carried on not as a tradition of dark magic per se, but is much more akin to Braucherei as simply a spiritual and magical tradition of healing and belief.

Whatever era we are living in, whether Judeo-Christian or not, we are confronted with similar joys and challenges in life, we have but to choose how we will act and interact in the world. Our ancestors carried on these heirlooms of healing wisdom, because it was useful to them, and this wisdom is passed on with the hope that it will prove sacred and useful for those to come. Braucherei is known as a way of healing by acting as a vessel for the Holy Spirit of creation.

One may be called a Hexe, with this word connoting malevolence, if indeed their way of being in the world deserves such a label. But if one is acting with integrity, acting as an open vessel for

the power of the Holy Spirit, then simply utilizing pre-Christian practices need not earn them the title of Black Magic. I call for the importance of respecting the strength and wisdom of our ancestors going back many generations and belief-systems.

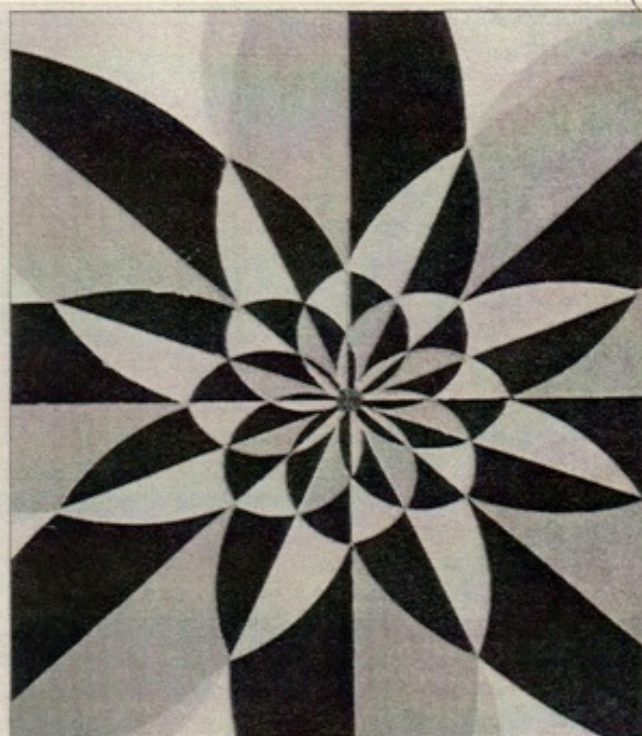
With the current American definition of Hexerei being a descriptor of malevolence, I respect and honor that usage. I also honor the fact that even today in many places of the world it does not carry that connotation. A recognition is in order that using ancient methods of healing may not in itself call for the practitioner being automatically included in the ranks of the sick of heart among us, the demonic forces among us. One fellow Braucher said to this topic, "It isn't our ancestors' fault that they were born before Christ. Heirloom healing ways can have a place in Braucherei today. It is up to each of us to be sure that we are acting in harmony with the Divine, whatever techniques we use." It is indeed up to each of us to focus on openness to Divine guidance. Use the appropriate tool for the appropriate job, and do so with compassionate integrity, whatever the circumstance.

Words and intentions are tools of power, wield them wisely.



"Even the mere layman can enjoy and benefit in many ways from the practice of painting "earthstars". Certain geometric and numerical configurations have always been held "sacred" since the stone age. Painting or pecking symbols in the rock cliffs has been so easy that even a "caveman" could do it. I like to make the analogy between "hex sign painting" and growing plants. Perhaps more precisely planting seeds. They both are creative acts. When planting a seed, all of the components of the mature plant are there in a very compact form. The results of the "planting" are not always known and the conscious intent of "planting" can be misleading. "Growth" occurs sometimes in such away that is not always anticipated. The subconscious mind needs only to be exposed to a conscious experience in order for it to manifest that experience's essence into a creative result.....all the stylized intent in the world cannot be a substitute for the irrational power of the paradox. Making a connection with the "Living Universe" is inevitably paradoxical and the results frequently a surprise!!"

Hunter Yoder +++



Hunter Yoder, hexologist, born and raised in Berks County, PA. Attended Kutztown State University and received a BFA in Painting. His work has been shown at the Museum of Modern Art in NYC and in Europe. He currently lives in Park Slope Brooklyn with his wife and 2 daughters.

"My point of origin in all of this has always been the hex sign. Painted them on my father's barn in Richmond Township near Virginville when about 16 years old. He grumbled at the extra cost and expense since the "job" was to just paint the whole barn, ha! But there they were, actually inscribed into the wood, the usual three on the front "bay" and one on either end, none on the back bank side. Eight pointed stars, with a radiating outer border. Made a big impression. I also grew up and went to school with the Claypoole family. You might know the father, Johnny. He took up hex sign painting from Johnny Ott of Lenhartsville, not too far down stream.

I loved Ott's work. It still was pretty visible then. He was basically a commercial painter with a little something extra. The interior of the Lenhartsville hotel, the main dining room is the "Sistine Chapel" of PA Hexology. He decorated all the walls free-form. I think he may have owned the place at one time. Ott is referred to by Lee R. Gandee in his book "Strange Experience:" A "rain" hex sign Ott painted evidently was left outside too long causing so much rain that the Delaware River flooded, causing 4 million dollars damage. Quite a large sum of money back in the fifties."





The Sacred Promise at Erntedankfesch

We are told that domestication is a uniquely human process, that we humans have found a way to dupe scores of plants, animals, and fungi into producing and operating their life cycles within a human context. What if the coin was turned the other way? The story could just as easily be told from the perspective of grain, cattle, or those cute little button mushrooms: They duped us into thinking that the only way to secure sustenance was to provide them with the perfect growing conditions, and jump at their every need to ensure a healthy and plentiful crop.

I prefer to hear a story of a sacred promise. With each and every single crop that human hands tend, with every animal who lives in partnership with human beings, with all that is domestic, we have made a sacred promise. The promise was made and kept for a very long time: we provide what they need to live, we protect them from predators, we care for them in disease. In return they promise us sustenance and medicine, the nurturance we need. We have always engaged in promoting natural selection to our benefit, as have they: we mate particular cattle to each other to promote larger and more robust animals, or greater amounts of milk; we save seed from grain plants with the largest, best tasting seed heads, with the greatest evidence of resistance to insects and disease. In return they have selected people who could digest milk, and vast quantities of grain, which is a reality very different from that of our most ancient ancestors.

Over the past century we have begun to ignore this sacred promise. Industrial agriculture does not honor the most important aspects of our pledge: to provide what they need to live healthy lives. Modern agriculture crams as many animals into a cage or stalls as they can, providing grain for their feed instead of an open pasture on which to graze. Animals are given steroids to make them larger and more robust, and a constant stream of antibiotics to prevent the inevitable outbreaks of disease in their cramped and vile conditions. These animals are not happy, not healthy, not safe. Mad cow disease, the rising problems in hormonal imbalance and cancer in humans, and the return of diseases once deemed dead come from the conditions of industrial agriculture, and point to a serious imbalance.

Grain is now genetically modified, crossed with the genes of beings that aren't even plants. Terminator seed technology means that farmers can no longer save their own seed for the next year's crop: it effectively kills the grain spirit we have honored for so long. We have already seen examples of these GM crop genes escaping into the wild, and into neighboring fields. We've seen farmers sued because GM crop genes were found in their fields. What was once the domain of all people has become the property of very few, held under the lock and key of patents, and held up for all to see with wonder as though it were pure gold. Though in reality this gold is only skin deep—just enough for the top CEO's and patent holders. Beneath that skin there is nothing but poison for the people, the animals, and the plants.

We are stepping outside of the boundaries of what the natural world can recognize. In Braucherei we believe that whatever action you make in the world, it will return to you, times three. What is this harvest we are reaping, and how can we stay so convinced that it is the only way when other ways have been with us for our entire existence as a species? It is far past time to renew our promise, our sacred vow to live in partnership with these friends of human kind, not in domination of them. The celebration of Harvest Home (Erntedankfesch) was traditionally held sometime between late August and early October. This celebration was held to honor the honest work of farmers, animals and crops alike. It was held to give thanks to God and all the hands that had touched the food to bring in a successful harvest.

Continued on page 16...

The Praiseworthy Virtues of the North

This list of praiseworthy ethics is taken directly from the lore of Northern Europe. Nothing listed is modern opinion but, instead, comes from the very words of our Northern European ancestors. These ancestors of the Northern European peoples are the source of what is thought to be praiseworthy. Their wisdom is timeless and what was praiseworthy then, is praiseworthy now.

What is Praiseworthy?

1. Gifting is praiseworthy.
2. Generosity is praiseworthy.
3. Moderation is praiseworthy.
4. The maintaining of frith* in all circumstances is praiseworthy.
5. Courage is praiseworthy.
6. The seeking of good over ill is praiseworthy.
7. Hospitality is praiseworthy.
8. Courtesy is praiseworthy.
9. Tolerance is praiseworthy.
10. The pursuit of wisdom and knowledge is praiseworthy.
11. The defense of freedom is praiseworthy.
12. Industriousness is praiseworthy.
13. Vigilance is praiseworthy.
14. The protection, nurturing and forbearing of kin is praiseworthy.
15. Showing respect for elders is praiseworthy.
16. Loyalty to friends and kin is praiseworthy.
17. Keeping an oath is praiseworthy.
18. Honoring the sanctity of marriage is praiseworthy.
19. Refraining from mockery is praiseworthy.
20. Refraining from arrogance is praiseworthy.
21. Making kin, honor and justice more important than gold is praiseworthy.
22. Cleanliness is praiseworthy.
23. The maintaining of one's dignity in all situations is praiseworthy.
24. Good organization is praiseworthy.
25. Persistence is praiseworthy.
26. The rule of law is praiseworthy.
27. To try one's steel against an opponent fairly is praiseworthy.
28. Respect for the dead is praiseworthy.
29. For a man to never strike a woman is praiseworthy.
30. To not abuse one's power is praiseworthy.

*Frith is an Old English word often (and usually over-simplistically) translated as "peace". Frith has a great deal to do not only with the state of peace but also with the nature of social relationships conducive to peace.

Our thanks to the Northvegr Foundation @ www.Northvegr.org

Sacred Promise continued from page 14...

It was the end of the grain harvest, the beginning of winter's preparation in earnest. It was a time when community came together in appreciation of their ability to work as a unit toward a necessary goal.

At Harvest Home we give thanks and recognize the sacrifices made by all in the interest of life. Like wise, it is appropriate to give thanks to our community- our strong and growing local economies, our organic and family farms, our dedicated volunteers. One of the best ways to honor your community, and to build community bonds, is to seek out those local farmers and businesses. Ensure that your dollars stay within your community by spending them there, strengthen the health future growth of our towns, cities, and farms by supporting the people who actually care about them, who are invested in them. Big box stores come and go with no care for the impact on

community business and local economy. Small local businesses stay through every kind of weather, pay their taxes, and benefit the community as a whole. They keep our downtown areas beautiful and pleasant places to live and work, and most importantly, they support our friends and neighbors.

At Harvest Home it is time to think about what sacrifices you can make to ensure the future health of your community. This year's harvest may be plentiful, but what will next year bring? What about twenty years from now? What will your children and grandchildren reap in harvest from the seeds you sow today? The problems facing humanity are great in our time, in order to see a tomorrow that is as beautiful as today we must all pull our share.

The sacred promise is one to all the earth: its plants, its animals, and its people. Lets begin to be good ancestors, give thanks, and make sacred our work.



No-Knead Harvest Brot

-3 cups all purpose or bread flour plus more for dusting(but recipe works equally well with whole wheat or rye flour)

-1/4 teaspoon instant yeast

-1 1/4 teaspoons salt

-cornmeal or wheat bran

1. In a large bowl combine the flour, yeast and salt. Add 1 5/8 cups water and stir until blended. Dough will be very sticky.

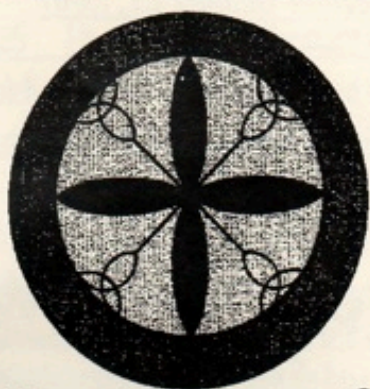
2. Cover with plate or plastic wrap. Let dough rest in a warm place (70 degrees) for at least 12 hours, but preferably 18 hours.

3. Dough is ready when the surface is dotted with bubbles. Lightly flour a work surface and place the dough on it and sprinkle with flour. No need to knead! Just fold it over on itself once or twice. Cover loosely with wrap and let it rest for about 15 minutes.

Using just enough flour to keep the dough from sticking to your hands or work surface, quickly and gently shape dough into a ball. Generously coat a cotton towel (not terry cloth) with flour, wheat bran or corn meal. Put the ball seam side down on the towel, dust with more flour, wheat bran or cornmeal and cover with another cotton towel and let rise for 2 hours. When it is ready, it will be double in size and will not readily spring back when poked with a finger. Turn oven to 450 when the dough has risen for 1 1/2 hours. Put a heavy 6-8 quart pot (with a cover) in the oven as it heats (cast iron, enamel ware, pyrex or ceramic) When the dough is ready, carefully remove the pot from the oven. Slide your hand under the towel and turn dough over into the hot pot, seam side up. It will look like a mess, but that's okay. Shake the pot once or twice if the dough is unevenly distributed; it will straighten out as it bakes. Cover with the lid and bake 30 minutes. Then remove the lid and bake another 15-30 minutes until the loaf is beautifully browned. Cool on a rack.

Yields one 1 1/2 pound loaf of delicious bread!
Adapted from a recipe from the Sullivan Street Bakery
533 West 47th Street NY, NY
NY Times November 2006





Jesse Tobin

Clinical Herbalist
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Three Sisters Center Workshops

August 4th Sommermit workshop 10-5pm

Pa German Cultural Heritage Center at Kutztown University

Come celebrate the apex of the creation cycle and the time of the first harvest. We will honor the balance of fire and water, growth and decline during this time of the summer solstice. Learn about the practice and evolution of traditional PA German Braucherei healing and spiritual practices

Optional seasonal Lunch using local organic ingredients -\$15



Saturday and Sunday, September 22-23, 2007

The Three Sisters Center and Farm at Coventry

will be spending the weekend at the
*3rd Annual Pennsylvania Renewable Energy
& Sustainable Living Festival*

In Kempton, PA for workshops & lectures on both days!

Come visit our exhibitor booth!

Check their website for info on times and registration

www.paenergyfest.com

Saturday October 27, 2007

10 am-5 pm

The Three Sisters Center of the Healing Arts

Presents Minnesota Herbalist

Matthew Wood AHG

"The Doctrine of Signatures"

and the

"4 Elements in Practical Herbalism"

Hosted at the Farm at Coventry

1333 Ridge Road Pottstown, PA 19465

610-469-9591 farmatcoventry@aol.com

\$95 Members price/ \$125 non-members

November 3 Alle Liebeziel (All Soul's Day) 10-5

Pa German Cultural Heritage Center at Kutztown University

This workshop will honor those friends, family, loved ones and teachers who have passed on. In ancient times, this day was seen as the final end of harvest time and the beginning of winter. Learn about traditional PA German beliefs and practices of the Halloween holiday.

Optional seasonal Lunch using local organic ingredients -\$15

Guild Gatherings at Farm at Coventry 1333 Ridge Road Pottstown, PA 610-469-9591

Please bring a bag lunch— Herbal beverages and snacks will be provided

August 25 10 am to 3 pm Creating a PA German Hex Sign

We will delve into the Symbols of Sacred Geometry found in the PA German Decorative Arts of hex signs and fraktur. There is also a good amount of plant and tree associations and symbolism . We will design our own sign to take home.

September 29 10am to 3pm Exploring Sacred Alphabets

Examine of the beauty, mystery and use of several sacred alphabets: Greek, Hebrew and Runic that have been found among Braucherei practitioners. We will explore the meanings and many uses of them in the Braucherei traditions. Also includes tree and plant symbology.

October 27 10 to 5 Matthew Wood- The Doctrine of Signatures and the 4 Elements in Practical Herbalism

Matthew Wood is a Minnesota herbalist and a member of the American Herbalists Guild (registered herbalist) and has a Masters of Science degree from the Scottish School of Herbal Medicine (accredited by the University of Wales). He is an author and lecturer and we are honored to have him return to Farm at Coventry again this year!

There will be no November and December Guild Gatherings due to the holidays. We'll meet you by the woodstove with hot tea in January, weather permitting!!

**Note: Guild Gatherings are pre-register events limited to 25. Please Register early!

Registration Form

Name

Address

Phone

email



	Optional Meal \$15	Member Price:	Non-Member
☐ Hollerbier Haven Annual Membership		\$25	
☐ August Guild Gathering 8/25	N/A	\$35	\$45
☐ September Guild Gathering 9/29	N/A	\$35	\$45
☐ Matthew Wood Workshop 10/27	Yes/No	\$95	\$125
☐ November Workshop 11/3	Yes/No	\$35	\$45
For meals add \$15 per event			
Grand Total			

To join the Hollerbier Haven Guild or to register for a gathering or workshop, please fill out the registration form completely and send along with a check or money order made payable to "Farm at Coventry"

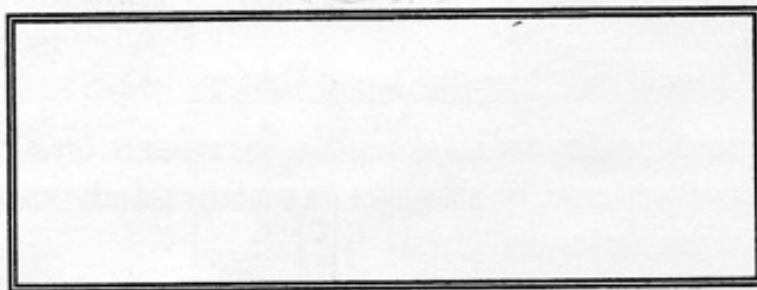
Send to: Farm at Coventry 1333 Ridge Rd Pottstown, PA 19465

Questions? Call 610-469-9591 or email farmatcoventry@aol.com

Three Sisters Center for the Healing Arts

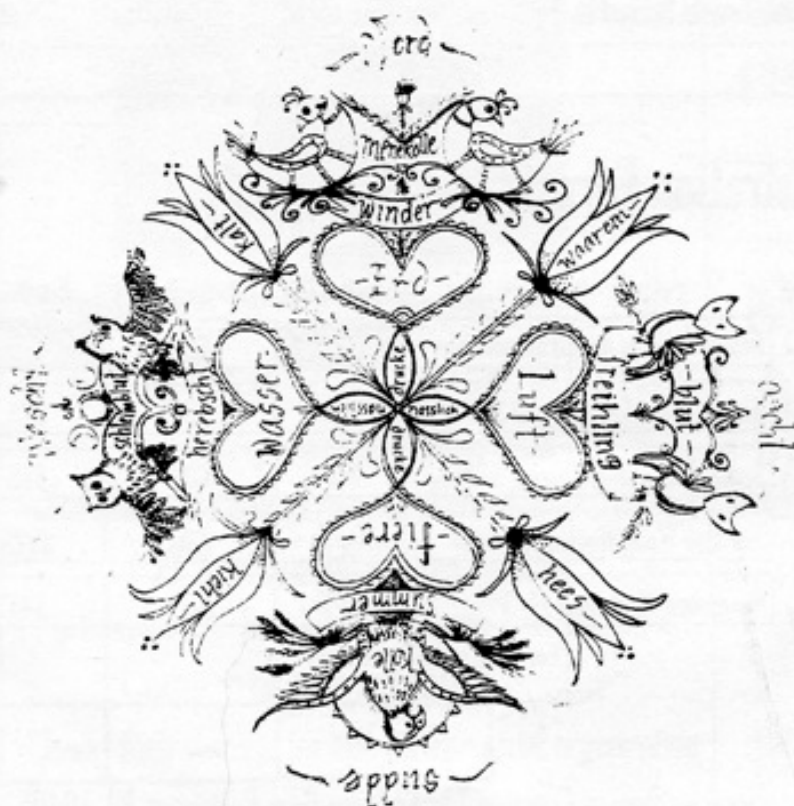
In two locations::

Farm at Coventry
1333 Ridge Road
Pottstown, PA 19465
and
The Pennsylvania
German Cultural
Heritage Center
22 Luckenbill Road
Kutztown, PA 19530



Visit our new website at www.ThreeSistersCenter.com

'Es Dietsches Medizinraad'



Our PA German medicine wheel is pictured at left. It draws heavily on the 4 Element Humoral theory of Greek medicine. This classical medicine wheel has been shifted, however, added to with Germanic wisdom as well as some information gleaned from life in Pennsylvania. Here, the four elements, Earth, Air, Fire and Water are associated with the four directions: North, East, South and West; the four seasons of the year, the 4 Humours, and the four birds of Power in the Braucherei tradition.